

Nakshatra Vatika

The 27 plants for a Nakshatra Vatika are plants associated with each of the 27 lunar mansions (nakshatras) in Hindu astrology, such as Ashwini (Kajra), Bharani (Amla), Krittika (Gular), Rohini (Jamun), and others like Peepal (Pushya), Nagkesar (Ashlesha), Banyan (Magha), and Palash (Purva Phalguni). Each tree is linked to a specific nakshatra and is believed to have unique benefits and influences.

Here are the 27 plants for a Nakshatra Vatika, with some variations noted between sources:

Nakshatra	Plant Name
Ashwini	Kajra (Poison nut) / Ashvattha (Peepal)
Bharani	Amla (Indian gooseberry) / Palash (Flame of the forest)
Krittika	Gular (Cluster fig) / Bamboo
Rohini	Jamun (Java plum) / Bamboo
Mrigashirsha	Khair (Cutch tree) / Kadamba
Ardra	Khadir (Black Eaglewood) / Kadamba
Punarvasu	Shami (Banyan) / Bamboo
Pushya	Ashoka (Ashoka tree) / Peepal (Sacred fig)
Ashlesha	Nagkesar (Indian rose chestnut) / Nagkesar (Nagakesara)
Magha	Banyan tree (Vata vruksh) / Vata Vruksh (Banyan tree)
Purva Phalguni	Dhava (Flame of the forest) / Palash (Flame of the forest)
Uttara Phalguni	Vata (Banyan tree) / Rudraksha
Hasta	Nyagrodha / Spondias pinnata

Chitra	Khajura / Aegle marmelos
Swati	Arka / Terminalia arjuna
Vishakha	Bilva (Wood apple) / Reetha (Soapnut)
Anuradha	Apamarga / Maulsari (Persian silk tree)
Jyeshtha	Vilva (Wood apple) / Neem (Indian lilac)
Mula	Ketaki / Babool (Acacia)
Purva Ashadha	Rakta Chandana (Red sandalwood) / Khameer (Indian almond)
Uttara Ashadha	Khadira (Black catechu) / Peepal (Sacred fig)
Shravana	Vata Vriksha (Banyan tree) / Harra (Chebulic myrobalan)
Dhanishta	Shami (Banyan) / Sheesham (Indian rosewood)
Shatabhisha	Apamarga / Picha-munda (Neem)
Purva Bhadrapada	Vata (Banyan tree) / Mawa (Madhuka)
Uttara Bhadrapada	Ashvattha (Peepal) / Mawa (Madhuka)
Revati	Ashoka (Ashoka tree) / Mawa (Madhuka)

Importence of Nakshatra Vatika

- Nakshatra Vatika, or sacred groves, are important for integrating astrology with Ayurveda and promoting holistic health. They are believed to provide spiritual and emotional benefits by connecting people to their birth nakshatra (lunar constellation) through associated plants. Their importance also lies in conserving rare medicinal plants, maintaining biodiversity, and potentially purifying the air, while also creating peaceful environments.

Astrological and spiritual significance

- **Personal connection:** Each of the 27 nakshatras is linked to a specific plant or tree. Spending time near the tree associated with one's birth star is believed to bring spiritual balance, health, and prosperity, according to Astrological beliefs.
- **Cosmic energy:** The gardens are designed to align with the cosmic energies of the stars, with the belief that each tree contributes to the well-being of individuals born under its respective nakshatra.

Medicinal and health benefits

- **Ayurvedic balance:** The plants in a Nakshatra Vatika are selected for their medicinal properties and are thought to help balance the body's doshas (Vata, Pitta, and Kapha).
- **Healing properties:** Many of these plants have scientifically recognized therapeutic properties used in traditional medicine for ailments like digestion issues and skin problems.
- **Environmental health:** These plants are believed to release more oxygen, and sitting among them can create a positive and refreshing environment, particularly in urban areas.

Conservation and biodiversity

- **Plant conservation:** Historically, these gardens served as a method for conserving rare and endangered medicinal plant species, ensuring their availability for future generations.
- **Biodiversity enrichment:** By creating these dedicated spaces, Nakshatra Vatikas help maintain and enrich biodiversity, especially in urban settings where green spaces are scarce.
- **Connection to nature:** They foster a deeper appreciation for nature and encourage environmental conservation by highlighting the intrinsic connection between plants, spirituality, and human well-being.